THE UNIVERSITY OF MELBOURNE

ASSESSING

COMMUNICATION

NEW METRICS: 2025

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WITH MANY THANKS TO
schools, industry and credentialing research-practice partners, whose contributions continue to combine with the broader work of the University of Melbourne to inform the development of this work.

Produced by
Melbourne Metrics
Faculty of Education
The University of Melbourne
Contact: assessment-community@unimelb.edu.au

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Assessment of Complex Competencies: A Poem

Assessment is
a **process**
of gathering evidence
from a **variety** of contexts
in which the learner can show what they are **capable** of
in a **complex** domain of learning
to support a **considered judgement**
about their position on a **scale** of competence
from less expert to more expert
representing what they know and can do
and what they need to learn next
with a **sufficient** degree of confidence
to support them in their learning
and to provide recognition of their attainment
that people can **trust**

- Enterprise Professor S. Milligan

THE UNIVERSITY OF MELBOURNE

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THE AMBITION

TRANSFORMING WHAT WE VALUE IN SCHOOLS

Current metrics in schooling favour narrow definitions of learning success, shaped by the industrial model, the old 'grammar of schooling', that are no longer sufficient in a modern education.

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A new 'grammar of schooling' empowers young people to be producers of their own learning and supports them to develop the human competencies required to thrive in a world of great technological advancement, where they face global challenges and opportunities, and a range of unknown career options.

Leading schools and school systems recognise that a broader range of metrics is required to support learners, teachers and school leaders to develop, assess and recognise the complex competencies young people need today.

The University of Melbourne has generated reliable and robust resources to support educational settings that have a strategic interest in:

- student agency in learning;
- advancing the way complex competencies are taught, assessed and reported on;
- credentialing learners at key transition points of schooling;
- engaging in professional learning to build staff capacity to lead new assessment practices;
- equipping students with sophisticated learning skills;
- contributing to the growing evidence-base for systemic change;
- using next-generation assessment and recognition approaches to leverage the transformation they wish to achieve.

Competency education is not an 'add on' to the existing features of schooling, rather an opportunity to learn knowledge and skills through developing and exercising competence in areas of interest.

Moving towards the new grammar of schooling is an opportunity to rethink the emphasis on standardisation in current practices and embrace the complexity of a more sophisticated student-centred approach to learning.

OLD GRAMMAR → NEW GRAMMAR

Features of the old grammar are familiar to educators and help hold the industrial model of schooling in place (e.g., learning and success defined by age/stage, teacher solely as content expert, standardised examinations, timetabled blocks of learning).

Educators leading transformation consider the shifts required to move from the old grammar to the new. Below is a micro-level example of the kinds of shifts required in learning and teaching.

OLD GRAMMAR FOCUS

Students **use feedback** to learn from mistakes and use teacher advice.

NEW GRAMMAR FOCUS

Students **generate feedback loops** to seek, use and give feedback to enhance performance, learning skills, learning partnerships and autonomy.

THE AMBITION

WHY COMPLEX COMPETENCIES?

A shift to the new grammar of schooling with a commitment to the development of complex competencies makes it imperative that students develop agency in learning.

Complex competencies might also be referred to as '21st Century skills'; 'soft skills'; 'general capabilities'; 'transferable skills', 'graduate attributes', 'approaches to learning', or similar. Despite the differences in name, all cover similar skills, attitudes and values that learners are expected to develop to thrive at school and in the future.

A complex competency is:

- teachable, learnable, observable, assessable;
- learned in the context of developing expertise in particular domains;
- developed inside and outside formal education;
- transferable across contexts, that is, competencies learned in one context or place that can be transferred to another*.

Agency in Learning is essential to the new grammar of schooling. This competency is considered fundamental to the development of all competencies.

AGENCY IN LEARNING

The capacity to produce learning of value to self or community

ACTING ETHICALLY

Acting in a way that is guided by moral principles (what we ought to do) in any situation

ACTIVE CITIZENSHIP

Contributing to the well-being of a community

COMMUNICATION

The ability to transmit, receive and interpret information, ideas, arguments, feelings and beliefs to support the purposes of the individual or group

COLLABORATION

Working with others to achieve a common goal

QUALITY THINKING

Thinking things through to achieve better outcomes for yourself or your group

PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT

The ability to live by the attitudes and behaviours that your communities value

FOR LEADERS

CONDITIONS THAT SUPPORT A TRANSFORMATIVE AGENDA

School leaders are in a position to optimise the conditions for teaching and learning of the complex competencies young people need in a modern education.

Transforming the 'grammar of schooling' takes bold, nurturing and influential leadership. Experienced transformative leaders describe these actions as levers for change.

LEADERS DO THIS...	SO THAT TEACHERS...	SO THAT LEARNERS CAN...
Champion learning ambitions that prepare learners for their life at school and beyond	Feel compelled and empowered to align their learning design and assessment practices	Feel empowered to learn according to their ambitions and interests
Privilege competencies as a focus of learning at the school	Design learning that includes a focus on learner competence	Have the opportunity to develop, exercise and demonstrate competence
Build a culture that values learner agency	Can be co-designers, coaches and facilitators of learning	Be empowered and responsible for their own learning and the learning of others
Consider the organisation of learning to prioritise relationships	Have the time and opportunity to work in depth with learners; to respond to their specific learning needs	Be truly known by their educators
Allow time and space for deep professional collaboration	Learn and work with colleagues from different ages, stages, learning areas, networks	Learn in transdisciplinary and multi-aged settings
Generate community interest and trust in the importance of competency education	Can work in partnership with students and families to develop learner competence	Be supported and recognised for what they know and can do, broadly defined, within and beyond the school
Prioritise next-gen assessment design	Can rethink the purpose of assessment	Know they are being recognised for a broad range of what they know and can do

A NOTE ON SCHOOL ASSESSMENT PRACTICES

It is important not to over-assess.

Complex competencies develop over time and with multiple exposures to opportunities to develop and exercise competence. They do not need to be measured at the beginning, middle and end of a unit of learning. It is recommended that teachers use the University's online assessment platform Ruby to assess a student in a particular competence no more than once or twice per year.

Unlike the attainment of domain-based knowledge or skills (e.g., in History or Maths), competence cannot be developed via direct instruction alone. Rather it is developed across a variety of occasions and contexts (e.g., collaboration can be developed in a Science class, a school musical, a group multi-domain inquiry project, etc).

School leaders align desired conditions for competence development with assessment protocols and schedules.

FOR LEADERS

USING NEXT-GENERATION RECOGNITION

Reporting and credentialing systems reflect what is valued in learning and can serve a variety of purposes for students, teachers and external stakeholders.

PURPOSE 1: PLANNING

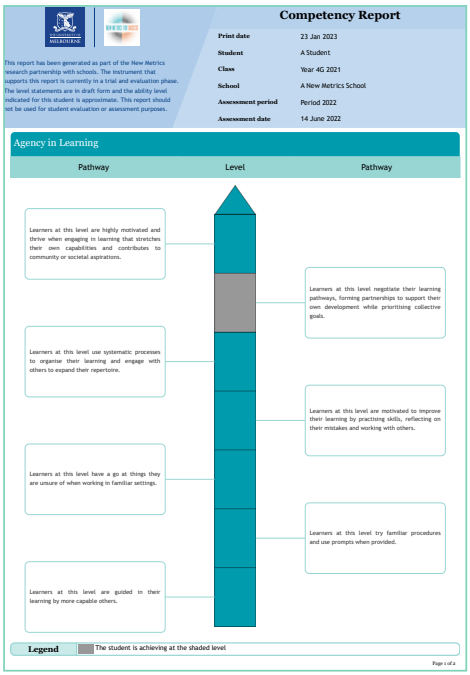
Teachers can use the University's online assessment platform, Ruby, to generate rocket reports for individual assessments of learners. These are useful for:

- planning 'next steps' for learners;
- informing learning design decisions;
- team discussions about learners and classes;
- reflection for teachers and learners.

Teacher planning also benefits from insights gained when learners share reflections on their own competence.

This serves the dual purpose of developing learner understanding of the competence (and why it is of value) and supporting teachers to plan for an individual learner's next steps.

A sample learner reflection tool is provided on p21. Before using such a tool, teachers should ensure learners understand the competence and its definition (through class discussions, sharing examples, etc) and how their reflections will be used to support their development.



This report has been generated as part of the New Metrics research partnership with schools. The instrument that supports this report is currently in a trial and evaluation phase. The level statements are in draft form and the ability level indicated for this student is approximate. This report should not be used for student evaluation or assessment purposes.

Competency Report

Print date	23 Jan 2023
Student	A Student
Class	Year 4G 2021
School	A New Metrics School
Assessment period	Period 2022
Assessment date	14 June 2022

Agency in Learning

Pathway | Level | Pathway

Learners at this level are highly motivated and thrive when engaging in learning that stretches their own capabilities and contributes to community or societal aspirations.

Learners at this level negotiate their learning pathways, forming partnerships to support their own development while prioritising collective goals.

Learners at this level use systematic processes to organise their learning and engage with others to expand their repertoire.

Learners at this level are motivated to improve their learning by practising skills, reflecting on their mistakes and working with others.

Learners at this level have a go at things they are unsure of when working in familiar settings.

Learners at this level try familiar procedures and use prompts when provided.

Learners at this level are guided in their learning by more capable others.

Legend: The student is achieving at the shaded level

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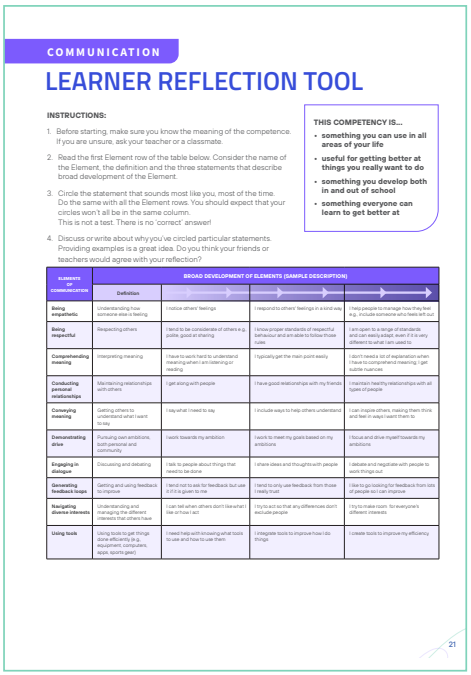

COMMUNICATION

LEARNER REFLECTION TOOL

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Before starting, make sure you know the meaning of the competence. If you are unsure, ask your teacher or a classmate.
2. Read the first Element row of the table below. Consider the name of the Element, the definition and the three statements that describe broad development of the Element.
3. Circle the statement that sounds most like you, most of the time. Do the same with all the Element rows. You should expect that your circles won't all be in the same column. This is not a test. There is no 'correct' answer!
4. Discuss or write about why you've circled particular statements. Providing examples is a great idea. Do you think your friends or teachers would agree with your reflection?

THIS COMPETENCY IS...
- **something you can use in all areas of your life**
- **useful for getting better at things you really want to do**
- **something you develop both in and out of school**
- **something everyone can learn to get better at**

ELEMENTS OF COMMUNICATION	BROAD DEVELOPMENT OF ELEMENTS (SAMPLE DESCRIPTION)			
	Definition			
Being empathetic	Understanding how someone else is feeling.	I notice others' feelings	I respond to others' feelings in a kind way	I help people to manage how they feel e.g., include someone who feels left out
Being respectful	Respecting others	I tend to be considerate of others e.g. polite, good at sharing	I know proper standards of respectful behaviour and am able to follow those rules	I am open to a range of standards and can easily adapt, even if it is very different to what I am used to
Comprehending meaning	Interpreting meaning	I have to work hard to understand meaning when I am listening or reading	I typically get the main point easily	I don't need a lot of explanation when I have to comprehend meaning; I get subtle nuances
Conducting personal relationships	Maintaining relationships with others	I get along with people	I have good relationships with my friends	I maintain healthy relationships with all types of people
Conveying meaning	Getting others to understand what I want to say	I say what I need to say	I include ways to help others understand	I can inspire others, making them think and feel in ways I want them to
Demonstrating drive	Pursuing own ambitions, both personal and community	I work towards my ambition	I work to meet my goals based on my ambitions	I focus and drive myself towards my ambitions
Engaging in dialogue	Discussing and debating	I talk to people about things that need to be done	I share ideas and thoughts with people	I debate and negotiate with people to work things out
Generating feedback loops	Getting and using feedback to improve	I tend not to ask for feedback but use it if it is given to me	I tend to only use feedback from those I really trust	I like to go looking for feedback from lots of people so I can improve
Navigating diverse interests	Understanding and managing the different interests that others have	I can tell when others don't like what I like or how I act	I try to act so that any differences don't exclude people	I try to make room for everyone's different interests
Using tools	Using tools to get things done (tools can be equipment, computers, apps, sports gear)	I need help with knowing what tools to use and how to use them	I integrate tools to improve how I do things	I create tools to improve my efficiency

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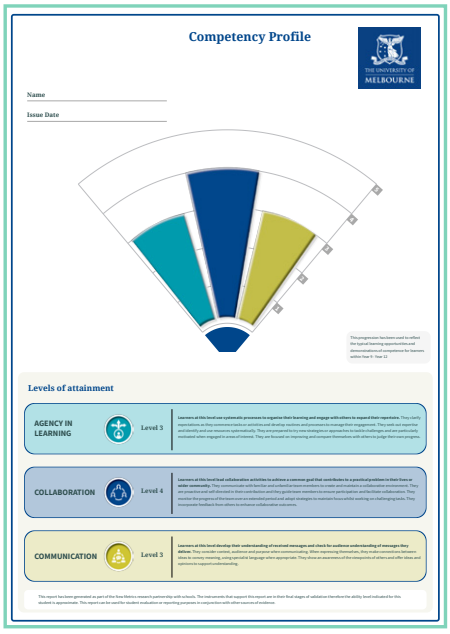
PURPOSE 2: SCHOOL REPORTING

Fan Profiles represent aggregated assessments for each competency, for multiple competencies. These are useful for:

- yearly or semesterly reporting to learners and families;
- professional discussions about learners and learning design.

Learner fan profiles can be generated each semester if the following requirements are met:

- A minimum of two competencies must be assessed;
- For each competency, a minimum of two valid assessments must be completed.



PURPOSE 3: CREDENTIALING

The Learner Competency Credential is issued to learners at key transition points in their education: primary to secondary; entry into senior secondary; end of senior secondary.

It captures aggregated assessments over time and recognises levels of learner attainment that are supported by robust moderation processes. It is formally warranted by The University of Melbourne.

Learners receive printable and digital credentials that have broad utility beyond their school for:

- transition from one educational setting to another (e.g., primary to secondary);
- admissions processes (e.g., tertiary entrance);
- internal qualifications (e.g., a Middle Years certificate);
- Employment.

Credentials can be generated at end of year if assessment and moderation requirements are met. Schools intending to generate credentials will work directly with the University team to understand these requirements and engage in a University-led school assessment audit.

Image:
The Australian Learner Competency Credential

FOR LEADERS

RUBY

Ruby is the University's platform that schools use to conduct formal assessments and generate reports and credentials.

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WHAT DOES RUBY DO?

Ruby invites teachers to check their judgements by answering a series of multiple-choice style questions about typical behavioural indicators of the competence being assessed. It uses teacher judgement to locate a learner on a standards-based learning progression and generates learner reports.

HOW DOES RUBY WORK?

Ruby will prompt the user to nominate the purpose of the assessment i.e. teachers choose whether the assessment is for teacher planning, or for school reporting or credentialing.

Depending on the age / stage of learning, and the purpose of the assessment and reporting, Ruby will ask fewer or greater number of questions. For example, an assessment conducted for the purposes of teacher planning may have approx. 10 questions, whereas an assessment contributing towards a credential may have approx. 22 questions.

WHAT REPORTS ARE GENERATED?

Regardless of the assessment purpose, all teacher assessments will auto-generate a rocket report. This includes teacher assessments that will contribute towards a learner fan profile or a credential.

TEACHERS MAKE MICRO-JUDGEMENTS BY RESPONDING TO QUESTIONS ABOUT A LEARNER.

Questions in Ruby aim to bring to the surface indicative behaviours of competence across a range of ages, stages and contexts.

The example provided here shows a model of the language and the broad steps of progression teachers will select from when recording their judgements in Ruby.

When debating or discussing ideas or issues with peers, does the learner:

- **contribute**
- **wait for their turn to speak**
- **take into account their peers' comments when contributing**
- **engage with others' points of view to improve or counter them**

FOR TEACHERS

HOW TO SUPPORT LEARNERS TO DEVELOP COMPETENCE

STEP 1.

FAMILIARISE YOURSELF with the competency. Use the following to strengthen a common understanding of the competency between teachers:

- competency definition (p13)
- age/stage appropriate learning progressions (p14 – 16)

In addition, it can be helpful to understand the composition of the competency

- elements of the competence (p17)
- broad development of elements (p18)

STEP 2.

CONSIDER LEARNING DESIGN that provides opportunity for students to learn, exercise and demonstrate competence.

- Does it provide you with opportunity to observe evidence of learners' competence over time?
- Does it allow you to privilege learner agency in the development of competence?
- How can the competency be developed across multiple contexts in connection with other goals (e.g., developing competence whilst also attaining knowledge)?
- Do you have the opportunity to truly know each student as a learner?

Teachers can use the teaching for competence table on p12 to examine the conditions they provide to learners to exercise competence and activate their agency in learning.

Importantly, to demonstrate more advanced levels of competence (i.e., Levels 4 and 5 in the learning progression) students must be provided with conditions that activate their agency as learners and go beyond direct instruction or scaffolded teaching.

STEP 3.

ASSESS & REPORT. Assessment must have a purpose. Determine the purpose of your assessment and have adequate evidence to support your judgement.

Refer to p8 & p9 to review reporting and credentialing options.

FOR TEACHERS

TEACHING FOR COMPETENCE

Great teaching draws from a rich repertoire, using different approaches for a variety of purposes and learners. There are times when direct instruction is the most appropriate activity. There are also times teachers can be mentors that support learner agency through the conditions they provide. This table highlights features to be considered when providing students the opportunity to learn, exercise and demonstrate competence.

Considerations for learning design and opportunity for agency	Purpose	Evidence of learning	Openness of process	Supervision	Scope of discipline knowledge and skill required	Authenticity	Scale	Connection to others
TEACHER AS MENTOR	Focuses on solving or participating in the solution of a practical problem for which the solution is unknown (i.e. goes beyond mastery of knowledge to application) Contributes to something of interest in their lives or community.	Learner curates and designs evidence used to demonstrate skill (e.g., portfolio) Evidence sourced inside and outside of school	The process is open and challenging, with little guidance provided by the teacher Allows for learners to conceptualise, construct, organise, analyse and test their own process, and make their own mistakes	Learner mentored and advised on request	Learners need to be self-directed and collaborate to master new and deeper knowledge and skill	Replicates real world experiences, or is a real-world experience Outcome has significance beyond the classroom	Requires long term (e.g., a semester) commitment and allows for flexible application Allows revisiting, reflection and reconceptualization of ideas and mistakes with opportunity for immersion	Learners independently build connections with new people and places outside of school
SCAFFOLDED TEACHING	Shaped, but not defined, by a learner's interests Includes choices within product or process	Learners negotiate how they will evidence their learning (e.g., product)	Process is defined with scope for interpretation and variation by the learner	Learner's work is supervised Provided with guidance, examples, modelling,	Requires application and exploration of knowledge or skill in the related domain that goes beyond what the learner already knows and can do Requires learner initiative to develop required knowledge or skill	Is relevant to the learners' immediate lives outside of the classroom	Scope for demonstrating depth and commitment (e.g., a five-week unit of work)	Learners independently connect with familiar people and places outside the classroom, (e.g., grandparents, neighbours)
DIRECTED INSTRUCTION	Goals, product, process, content determined by the teacher Context selected by the teacher so it is likely to appeal to learners	Learners use provided templates to demonstrate learning (e.g., worksheet, template for a project)	Learner provided with familiar steps to follow	The learner is directed and supervised	Requires knowledge or skill that is mostly already known to the learner	Designed for classroom learning	Short, fixed duration (e.g., a focus for a few days) time limited, timetabled	Involves familiar school-based people Connection with external others is planned and facilitate by the school

COMMUNICATION

The ability to transmit, receive and interpret information, ideas, arguments, feelings and beliefs to support the purposes of the individual or group

COMMUNICATION

LEARNING PROGRESSIONS

Assessors can recognise a learner's competence on a continuum of development known as a learning progression.

The following learning progressions take into account a broad range of ages/stages of development. They represent the qualitative leaps in development of competence; reflecting the growth in sophistication of application of competence that arises as learners develop in age and throughout typical stages of schooling.

The progressions can be used to:

- develop teacher and learner understanding of growth in the competence;
- report on learner attainment and growth.

Competence is hierarchical and those at higher levels can and should still use the things they learned at lower levels to operate expertly in different contexts. Being at a higher level means one has at their disposal a wider and deeper repertoire to deploy as required.

The developmental levels are broad, as capacity to perform at a level derives from a complex amalgam of skills, knowledge, attitudes and values. No two individuals operating at the same level will act in the same way, as there are different ways to express their capabilities.

KINDERGARTEN – YEAR 4

Level		Level Statement
5	THE INFLUENTIAL COMMUNICATOR	**Learners at this level use their communication skills to explore and negotiate new meanings, to impact others and influence action.** They use different tools and modes of communication in innovative ways to maximise impact and engagement. They are persuasive, clear, and able to engage in some complex communications. They are attuned to their audiences and take responsibility for negotiating shared meaning, responding to and engaging with diverse interests or perceptions. They are equally adept at communicating with individuals and with larger audiences and are able to use communication to deepen their own understandings while helping to develop the understandings of others.
4	THE ATTUNED COMMUNICATOR	**Learners at this level work effectively to build and share complex, nuanced meaning and achieve their communication purposes by generating impactful responses in their audiences.** They can engage with audiences that have diverse interests or perspectives and can tailor content and style to suit their purposes, employing different conventions or specialist language as required. They are mindful and careful about the impact of their communications on others. They monitor impact through feedback and dialogue, facilitating and negotiating shared understandings.
3	THE ACTIVE COMMUNICATOR	**Learners at this level focus on interpreting and conveying meaning, checking their own and their audience's understandings, and adapting their choice of style and content as required.** They can present a credible story or explanation that suits their audience and context, selecting and applying appropriate communication tools and styles. They engage with others, using discussion, debate and argument to negotiate shared meaning in familiar contexts. They understand that others have different interests and perspectives, and they cater to these to enable understanding. They respond to questions and feedback, and they recognise and try to correct misunderstandings and address any ill feelings engendered.
2	THE TRANSACTIONAL COMMUNICATOR	**Learners at this level share information, converse in familiar contexts, and are aware of their audience.** They offer information, ideas and opinions and seek them from others, following conventional communication protocols. They use images, signs and symbols to assist communication and take context into consideration. When presenting, they acknowledge their audience and choose an appropriate style from familiar methods, approaches and tools. When listening, they indicate attention and respond based on their interpretation of what they heard. They provide a range of acknowledgement of understanding to others and ask questions or use paraphrasing to make sure they understand the intended meaning.
1	THE FUNCTIONAL COMMUNICATOR	**Learners at this level are learning to express their basic needs and wants.** They use familiar language styles, in familiar contexts, with familiar tools. They select and share content based on their own interests and perceptions. They are guided by others when selecting the manner in which to communicate or the tools to use.

YEAR 5 – YEAR 8

Level		Level Statement
5	THE INFLUENTIAL COMMUNICATOR	**Learners at this level are creative users of their communication skills, exploring and negotiating new ideas and meanings to influence others and inspire action.** They use, integrate and adapt different tools and modes of communication in innovative ways to maximise impact and engagement. They are able to navigate complex communications and they develop and deliver persuasive, clear explanations and arguments. They are sensitive to their audience and adept at negotiating shared meaning, responding to and engaging with a range of interests or perceptions. They are comfortable and effective communicating with individuals or with larger groups, adding to their own understandings while developing the understandings of others.
4	THE ATTUNED COMMUNICATOR	**Learners at this level work effectively to build and share complex, nuanced meaning and achieve their communication purposes by generating impactful responses in their audiences.** They can engage with audiences that have diverse interests or perspectives and can tailor content and style to suit their purposes, employing different conventions or specialist language as required. They are mindful and careful about the impact of their communications on others. They monitor impact through feedback and dialogue, facilitating and negotiating shared understandings.
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2	THE TRANSACTIONAL COMMUNICATOR	**Learners at this level share information, converse easily in familiar contexts, and are aware of their audience.** They offer information, ideas and opinions and seek them from others, following conventional communication protocols. They use images, signs and symbols to assist communication and take context into consideration. When presenting, they acknowledge their audience and choose an appropriate style from familiar methods, approaches and tools. When listening, they indicate attention and respond based on their interpretation of what they heard. They provide a range of feedback to others and ask questions or use paraphrasing to make sure they understand the intended meaning.
1	THE FUNCTIONAL COMMUNICATOR	**Learners at this level are adept at expressing their needs and wants explicitly or implicitly, transmitting and receiving information, and participating in social interaction in their community.** They respond and give directions, and share information using familiar language styles, in familiar contexts, with familiar tools. They select and share content based on their own interests and perceptions. They are guided by others when selecting the manner in which to communicate or the tools to use. They notice the effects of their communications on others.

YEAR 9 – YEAR 12

Level		Level Statement
5	THE INFLUENTIAL COMMUNICATOR	**Learners at this level creatively harness their communication skills, exploring and negotiating new meanings to impact others and influence or inspire action.** Not bound by learned conventions, they use, integrate and adapt different tools and modes of communication in innovative ways to maximise impact and engagement. They are persuasive, clear and empathetic, and are able to navigate nuanced, implicit or complex communications. They are highly attuned to their audiences and take responsibility for negotiating shared meaning, responding to and engaging with diverse interests or perceptions. They are equally adept at communicating with individuals and with larger audiences and are able to use communication to deepen their own understandings while developing the understandings of others.
4	THE ATTUNED COMMUNICATOR	**Learners at this level work effectively to build and share complex, nuanced meaning and achieve their communication purposes by generating impactful responses in their audiences.** They can engage with audiences that have diverse interests or perspectives and can tailor content and style to suit their purposes, employing different conventions or specialist language as required. They are mindful and careful about the impact of their communications on others. They monitor impact through feedback and dialogue, facilitating and negotiating shared understandings.
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COMMUNICATION

ELEMENTS OF COMPETENCE

The University of Melbourne's assessment architecture includes foundational elements of competence.

Each complex competency is a combination of foundational elements of competence, wherein the whole (competency) is greater than the sum of its parts (elements).

When designing learning, teachers should primarily provide opportunity for the competence to be exercised and observed, rather than, for example, planning lessons that align with each element.

One might consider the elements as puzzle pieces or building blocks of the competence, or as vital organs that make a living thing.

Understanding these elements can be helpful in forming teachers conception of the competence, for inspiring learning design, and for tuning into the evidence of competence development.

The Elements (the 'building blocks' of competence)

The University's assessment architecture, including the learning progressions and elements, provides a 'currency' of competency assessment which can be used to assess a broad range of competencies.

This underpinning, standards-based assessment architecture allows students who are learning in different contexts, curricula and learning designs to be assessed and recognised in a robust and comparable way.

ELEMENTS OF

COMMUNICATION

The ability to transmit, receive and interpret information, ideas, arguments, feelings and beliefs to support the purposes of the individual or group

DEFINITION:

BEING EMPATHETIC

—

The ability to be sensitive to another person's feelings or states of mind

DEFINITION:

BEING RESPECTFUL

—

The ability to give due regard to others (their preferences, roles, rights, expectations, abilities, relationships)

DEFINITION:

COMPREHENDING MEANING

—

The ability to interpret meaning from diverse forms of communication (spoken, non-verbal, written, performative, recorded)

DEFINITION:

CONDUCTING PERSONAL RELATIONSHIPS

—

The ability to establish and sustain personal relationships

DEFINITION:

CONVEYING MEANING

—

The ability to communicate meaning to an audience by spoken, written, graphical or other expressive means

DEFINITION:

DEMONSTRATING DRIVE

—

The ability to propel the pursuit of social, personal or community ambitions

DEFINITION:

ENGAGING IN DIALOGUE

—

The ability to engage in dialogue to connect to others, explore, negotiate meaning, or develop new perspectives

DEFINITION:

GENERATING FEEDBACK LOOPS

—

The ability to generate and use feedback for improved performance

DEFINITION:

NAVIGATING DIVERSE INTERESTS

—

The ability to manage diverse or conflicting interests, needs, customs, or values

DEFINITION:

USING TOOLS

—

The ability to use tools (equipment, instruments, machines, software, heuristics, theories) to extend productivity

COMMUNICATION

UNDERSTANDING THE ELEMENTS OF COMPETENCE

It can be helpful to understand what broad development in the foundational elements of a competency looks like. This supports teachers to align their learning and assessment design.

It is important to remember that the synergy of the elements is what makes a complex competency. For example, whilst focusing on the development of a single element will indeed contribute to a learner's qualities, having a view to the marked leaps of development of the complex competence as a whole (the progressions) is crucial.

ELEMENTS OF COMMUNICATION	BROAD DEVELOPMENT OF ELEMENTS (SAMPLE DESCRIPTION)			
	Definition			
Being empathetic	The ability to be sensitive to another person's feelings or states of mind	Notices others' feelings or states of mind	Responds with understanding to others' feelings or states of mind	Engages with others' feelings or states of mind to help them learn or grow
Being respectful	The ability to give due regard to others (their preferences, roles, rights, expectations, abilities, relationships)	Follows familiar behavioural conventions	Acknowledges individual needs, rights or preferences in others	Adapts conventions and behaviour to accommodate differences
Comprehending meaning	The ability to interpret meaning from diverse forms of communication (spoken, non-verbal, written, performative, recorded)	Understands literal meaning	Interprets meaning from complex messaging or explicit instruction	Interprets context-dependent, nuanced meaning that may be implicit
Conducting personal relationships	The ability to establish and sustain personal relationships	Conducts typical social interactions	Exhibits healthy positive relationships with friends and peers	Is widely trusted as a friend or colleague, even outside their particular friendship group
Conveying meaning	The ability to communicate meaning to an audience by spoken, written, graphical or other expressive means	Delivers information	Effectively imparts a clear narrative; imparts understanding or knowhow	I can inspire others, making them think and feel in ways I want them to
Demonstrating drive	The ability to propel the pursuit of social, personal or community ambitions	Participates in activities	Pursues ambitions conscientiously	Demonstrates drive and focus; goes above and beyond
Engaging in dialogue	The ability to engage in dialogue to connect to others, explore, negotiate meaning, or develop new perspectives	Conducts transactional interactions	Connects with others to share ideas, information or feelings	Negotiates understandings, interprets ideas, and explores points of view to develop novel or shared perspectives
Generating feedback loops	The ability to generate and use feedback for improved performance	Makes adjustments as instructed	Seeks and uses available feedback	Pursues a wide range of opportunities and sources to give and receive feedback to enhance performance
Navigating diverse interests	The ability to manage diverse or conflicting interests, needs, customs, or values	Acknowledges diversity	Accommodates diversity	Capitalises on diversity
Using tools	The ability to use tools (equipment, instruments, machines, software, heuristics, theories) to extend productivity	Uses tools as provided	Selects or adapts tools	Creates or engineers tools to enhance productivity or performance

COMMUNICATION

LEARNER REFLECTION TOOL

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Before starting, make sure you know the meaning of the competence. If you are unsure, ask your teacher or a classmate.
2. Read the first Element row of the table below. Consider the name of the Element, the definition and the three statements that describe broad development of the Element.
3. Circle the statement that sounds most like you, most of the time. Do the same with all the Element rows. You should expect that your circles won't all be in the same column. This is not a test. There is no 'correct' answer!
4. Discuss or write about why you've circled particular statements. Providing examples is a great idea. Do you think your friends or teachers would agree with your reflection?

THIS COMPETENCY IS...

- **something you can use in all areas of your life**
- **useful for getting better at things you really want to do**
- **something you develop both in and out of school**
- **something everyone can learn to get better at**

ELEMENTS OF COMMUNICATION	BROAD DEVELOPMENT OF ELEMENTS (SAMPLE DESCRIPTION)			
	Definition			
Being empathetic	Understanding how someone else is feeling	I notice others' feelings	I respond to others' feelings in a kind way	I help people to manage how they feel e.g., include someone who feels left out
Being respectful	Respecting others	I tend to be considerate of others e.g., polite, good at sharing	I know proper standards of respectful behaviour and am able to follow those rules	I am open to a range of standards and can easily adapt, even if it is very different to what I am used to
Comprehending meaning	Interpreting meaning	I have to work hard to understand meaning when I am listening or reading	I typically get the main point easily	I don't need a lot of explanation when I have to comprehend meaning; I get subtle nuances
Conducting personal relationships	Maintaining relationships with others	I get along with people	I have good relationships with my friends	I maintain healthy relationships with all types of people
Conveying meaning	Getting others to understand what I want to say	I say what I need to say	I include ways to help others understand	I can inspire others, making them think and feel in ways I want them to
Demonstrating drive	Pursuing own ambitions, both personal and community	I work towards my ambition	I work to meet my goals based on my ambitions	I focus and drive myself towards my ambitions
Engaging in dialogue	Discussing and debating	I talk to people about things that need to be done	I share ideas and thoughts with people	I debate and negotiate with people to work things out
Generating feedback loops	Getting and using feedback to improve	I tend not to ask for feedback but use it if it is given to me	I tend to only use feedback from those I really trust	I like to go looking for feedback from lots of people so I can improve
Navigating diverse interests	Understanding and managing the different interests that others have	I can tell when others don't like what I like or how I act	I try to act so that any differences don't exclude people	I try to make room for everyone's different interests
Using tools	Using tools to get things done efficiently (e.g., equipment, computers, apps, sports gear)	I need help with knowing what tools to use and how to use them	I integrate tools to improve how I do things	I create tools to improve my efficiency

THE UNIVERSITY OF MELBOURNE

assessment-community@unimelb.edu.au

https://education.unimelb.edu.au/melbourne-assessment/home/partnerships